

Human-as-a-Service (HaaS): Write-Up

Problem

AI agents handle digital tasks well and stall on anything that needs a person: phoning a clinic, waiting in line for a product drop, inspecting a Facebook Marketplace item before purchase, picking something up. Human task pools exist (Prolific, TaskRabbit, Fiverr, crypto bounty platforms), and agent payment rails exist (x402, Payman), but no flow lets an agent dispatch a task to a vetted human, receive the result, and pay that person instantly in stablecoin. Existing Cardano agent marketplaces cover digital tasks only. In the US, the gig economy already runs on slow payouts and platform lock-in: workers wait days for funds and pay platform fees of 10-20%, while an agent can't open an account on any of these platforms.

Solution

HaaS is an endpoint any agent or person can call to hire a verified human. The agent first tries to complete the task with other AI agents. When none can, it escalates to HaaS, which posts a bounty, locks payment in escrow, matches the best available worker, verifies the returned result, and releases payment. The caller gets the result in the same thread. Example: a user texts "book the earliest physical therapy slot at a clinic in San Francisco this week." The clinic only books by phone, so a nearby worker makes the call, submits the date, time and confirmation number, and is paid \$5 in USD stablecoin on confirmation.

Technical approach

Payments: x402 settles USD-pegged stablecoin payments (USDM/USDCx) through a Cardano facilitator, with no accounts or API keys.

Escrow and refunds: Masumi escrow locks the bounty on posting, releases on confirmed completion, and auto-refunds on timeout or rejected work.

Identity: each worker is wrapped in a verifiable "verified worker" credential (Veridian) with a rating that accumulates per completed task.

Agent: an LLM decides what it can do itself versus what needs a human, writes the bounty, and checks the returned result against the task spec before releasing funds.

Matching engine: a chain-agnostic routing layer pulls workers from rent-a-human APIs (Prolific-style microtask pools, TaskRabbit-style errand pools, crypto bounty pools) and ranks them on skill, US metro area, rating, price and availability.

Interface: iMessage via Sendblue for requesters and workers, with SMS fallback. iMessage is the default messaging app for a large share of US phone users, so workers need no app and requesters stay in the thread they already use. A web dashboard shows bounty status and escrow state.

Chain pluggability: the matching and chat layers don't depend on the chain. Settlement is a config switch, so the same task can settle on Solana with USDC.

Real-world deployment and scale

HaaS sits downstream of every agent router, so demand grows with the number of agents deployed. Launch in a few dense US metros (Bay Area, New York, Los Angeles), where worker supply and errand demand are highest, then expand city by city. Supply scales by adding worker pools behind the open router; each new platform widens coverage by region and skill without changing the caller's API. Escrow, auto-refund, and ratings address the trust problem for both sides without a central intermediary, and instant payout removes the multi-day wait US gig workers face on traditional platforms.

Scope is limited to legitimate tasks (calls, errands, verification, queueing, translation, labeling), and a confirm-before-release step gates every payout. For US deployment, workers would be onboarded as independent contractors with identity verification and tax reporting (W-9/1099) handled at the credential-issuance step, and stablecoin payouts would route through a regulated on-ramp. Next steps are credential issuance at worker onboarding, dispute handling through Masumi, and mainnet deployment with real stablecoin liquidity.